Saeed's cousin (and brother-in-law), and so it is questionable whether he could or would have deployed Brigitte without the senior leadership's sanction. Nevertheless, it is possible Sajid was acting on behalf of a faction within the group or that there was disunity about the decision to support this operation. In either case, the operation illustrates Lashkar's capacity to project power far beyond South Asia as well as its direct involvement in terrorism directed against a Western target years prior to the Mumbai attacks.

Domestically, the group's policy remained to abjure violence against the state. However, there are indications Lashkar, or at least operatives associated with it, provided logistical support for one and possibly both of the assassination attempts against President Musharraf that took place within a fortnight in 2003. On 14 December would-be assassins exploded a bomb under a bridge in Rawalpindi less than a minute after Musharraf's motorcade had crossed it. The bridge was roughly a mile away from the general headquarters of the Pakistan army, and several air force personnel were later found to have been involved in the plot. Eleven days later there was a second attack, not far from the bridge where the first attempt occurred. This time two suicide bombers each drove a vehicle full of explosives into Musharraf's convoy. One of them turned out to have been a member of Jaish-e-Mohammad, the other formerly belonged to Harkat-ul-Jihad-al-Islami. Both had fought in Afghanistan alongside the Taliban. At least two commandos from Pakistan's Special Services Group were involved as was a police officer who provided information about when Musharraf's motorcade would arrive at the pre-selected attack location. Al-Qaeda is believed to have provided the explosives training and contributed to the attack planning as well.[232]

Additional manpower, resources and other logistical support came from a mix of several Pakistani militant groups, including Lashkar, according to three of the author's interlocutors. One is a Western diplomat based in Pakistan at the time of writing and another a former US intelligence officer. Both were stationed in Pakistan at the time of the attempts on Musharraf's life. Each, independently and unprompted by mention of the other, recounted a similar version of events; they stated that members from Lashkar were part of a congeries of actors involved in the December 2003 attacks against Musharraf. Both believe that members of the group provided reconnaissance and possibly other logistical support for the